

Add Superpowers to your Tests with Taiko

Taiko is a free and open source browser automation tool built from the ground up to make browser automation reliable. It is a node library to automate Chromium based browsers like Google Chrome, Microsoft Edge and Opera, using JavaScript. Its simple API, smart selectors and implicit waits make tests highly readable and maintainable. Taiko uses Chrome DevTools to automate Chromium.



Figure 1: UI test suite issues

UI testing is critical to find out if the application under test is of the best possible quality, mimicking the actual user interactions. This means that the tests open a browser and interact with the application, in the same manner that an actual user would. Having said that, we need to be very cautious while writing such test suites, because they have a reputation of failing for reasons that may not be

entirely related to functionality. This means you will often hear comments like those represented in Figure 1.

Teams end up with 'flaky test suites' and they lose confidence in the automated suites. This results in the team ignoring failed tests, in order to pass quality tests. This happens often, resulting in dangerous quality compromises for your application.

Surely, there is a better way to make testing more reliable.

Installing Taiko

Installing Taiko is really simple. It is available in the *npm* registry.

When Taiko gets installed, it downloads the Chromium browser. This eliminates one of the biggest hassles of browser automation. There are no drivers, build tools or linking to a browser executable. You can start writing tests right after installation.

Taiko has a basic runner to run test scripts, and also integrates easily with other